



My Links Manager

catalog, links, control



Functional Documentation

My Links Manager is a Laravel-based website catalog with a public interface, AdminLTE control panel, installer, multilingual UI, and high-volume link import/export tools.

Product	My Links Manager
Primary stack	Laravel 13, PHP 8.4, MySQL 8.4, Apache 2, AdminLTE 4
Document language	English
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This document describes the main functional behavior of the system for administrators, maintainers, and implementation teams.

DOCUMENT MAP

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1. PRODUCT OVERVIEW AND ROLES

Product Overview

My Links Manager provides a structured website catalog. Visitors can browse catalog categories, open site cards, submit new websites for moderation, read catalog rules, and send feedback. Administrators manage catalog data through a dedicated AdminLTE control panel.

Primary roles

- Visitor - browses public catalog pages, opens site cards, follows external website links, and uses public forms.
- Contributor - submits a website through the public add-site form for administrator review.
- Administrator - manages links, categories, messages, settings, users, imports, and exports.
- Maintainer - runs Docker, migrations, seeders, tests, and screenshot jobs.

Core modules

Area	Main route	Purpose
Frontend	/	Public browsing, site details, add-site form, rules, feedback, and sitemaps.
Admin dashboard	/cp	Operational overview with metrics, link statuses, quick actions, and latest activity.
Links	/cp/links	Create, edit, view, delete, import, export, and moderate catalog links.
Catalog	/cp/catalog	Manage the category tree and category icons.
Feedback	/cp/feedback	Review messages submitted from the public feedback form.

2. PUBLIC FRONTEND FUNCTIONALITY

Public Frontend

The public frontend is designed as a clean website catalog. The header contains the project logo, main navigation, add-site call to action, and language switcher. The visual style follows the My Links Manager logo colors and uses consistent cards, buttons, forms, placeholders, and focus states.

Catalog homepage

- Displays top-level catalog categories in responsive cards.
- Shows category icons or a shared SVG placeholder when no custom icon exists.
- Centers category titles when a category has no visible subcategories.
- Links each category card to the corresponding catalog section.

Catalog section and site card

- Category pages list published links within the selected catalog section.
- Site cards show the site image or SVG placeholder, title, description, date, and detail button.
- The site detail page shows the complete description and available metadata.
- External redirects are handled through a dedicated route so visits can be counted.

Public forms

Area	Main route	Purpose
Add site	/add-url	Collects site name, category, URL, short and full description, keywords, banner HTML, and captcha.
Feedback	/contact	Collects visitor name, email, and message, then stores it for admin review.
Language	/language	Switches the interface locale and persists the selection.

3. ADMIN PANEL FUNCTIONALITY

Admin Panel

The admin panel is available at /cp after authentication. It uses AdminLTE 4, a dark sidebar, top language switcher, current administrator login display, and a footer with author information.

Dashboard

- Shows summary blocks for total links, categories, feedback messages, and links pending review.
- Displays link status distribution with progress bars.
- Provides quick actions for adding, importing, exporting, and creating categories.
- Shows top viewed links and latest catalog activity.

Admin sections

Area	Main route	Purpose
Links	/cp/links	Primary catalog record management with list actions, detail view, and status controls.
Catalog	/cp/catalog	Category management with parent-child hierarchy and image upload.
Feedback	/cp/feedback	Message list with truncated message preview and detail view.
Administrators	/cp/admins	Admin user management.
Settings	/cp/settings	Project configuration records.

4. LINK LIFECYCLE AND STATUSES

Link Lifecycle

Links can be created from the admin panel, submitted through the public form, or imported from files. Administrators review and change records before publishing them in the public catalog.

Link data

- Required fields include name, category, URL, and description.
- Optional fields include phone, email, city, keywords, full description, and HTML banner.
- URLs may be entered with or without a scheme. The application normalizes URL handling where needed.
- Date columns are formatted as human-readable values in the admin interface.

Statuses

Pending	The link is waiting for administrator review.
Published	The link is visible in the public catalog.
Blocked	The link is blocked and highlighted as blocked in admin views.

Status labels and AdminLTE color classes are centralized in `App\Enums\LinkStatus`. Views and controllers do not hardcode status colors.

5. CATALOG CATEGORIES

Catalog Category Management

Catalog categories form the navigation structure of the public catalog. Categories can be nested, localized during installation, and displayed with custom icons or placeholders.

Functional behavior

- Administrators can create and edit categories from /cp/catalog.
- Each category can have a parent category, title, keywords, description, and icon.
- Category icons support common web image formats.
- Frontend category cards adapt when subcategories are present or absent.
- Default categories are seeded by CatalogSeeder according to the selected installer locale.

Default category seeding

The installer runs database seeders after a successful database connection and administrator setup. CatalogSeeder chooses localized default categories based on the active installer locale and falls back to the configured fallback locale when needed.

6. IMPORT AND EXPORT

Import And Export

Import workflow

- The import page accepts a regular file or ZIP archive in one form with a single Import button.
- The button is disabled while import is running to prevent duplicate submissions.
- After completion or failure, the interface displays a dialog with the result.
- CSV and TXT files are processed line by line. XLS and XLSX files use chunk reading.
- ZIP archives are scanned for supported import files and processed through the same import pipeline.

Supported formats

CSV	TXT	XLS	XLSX
ZIP	TXT export	XLSX export	ZIP export

7. INSTALLER AND FIRST-RUN SETUP

Installer

The installer is automatically available when the root `.env` file does not exist. When `.env` exists, installer access redirects to the public homepage.

Installation steps

Area	Main route	Purpose
License	/install	Shows the license agreement and language selector.
Requirements	/install/requirements	Checks PHP version and required extensions.
Permissions	/install/permissions	Checks writable storage and cache directories.
Database	/install/database	Validates database connection credentials.
Administrator	/install/admin	Creates the first administrator account.
Complete	/install/complete	Confirms successful installation.

Docker database defaults

Host	mysql
Port	3306
Database	laravel_catalog
Username	laravel
Password	secret

8. LOCALIZATION

Localization

The interface supports five languages across the frontend, admin panel, and installer. Translations are stored in Laravel language files under resources/lang.

ru - Russian	en - English	fr - French	de - German
es - Spanish			

Language behavior

- Users can switch language from the frontend header.
- Administrators can switch language from the admin top bar.
- Installer language selection is applied to installer labels and seed data.
- The selected locale is persisted and reused after page reloads and login.

9. OPERATIONAL COMMANDS AND CONFIGURATION

Operational Commands

Common Docker commands

Start	<code>docker compose -f docker/docker-compose.yml up -d</code>
Rebuild	<code>docker compose -f docker/docker-compose.yml up -d --build</code>
Stop	<code>docker compose -f docker/docker-compose.yml down</code>
Shell	<code>docker exec -it laravel_catalog_app bash</code>
Tests	<code>docker exec -w /var/www/html laravel_catalog_app php artisan test</code>
Clear cache	<code>docker exec -w /var/www/html laravel_catalog_app php artisan optimize:clear</code>

Screenshots

The `screenshot:make` command selects up to 10 links without an image, checks URL availability, and saves screenshots to `public/uploads/url`. For full-page screenshots, configure `GOOGLE_API_KEY`.

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